

2.3 Flash Drives

2.3.1 Bootable Flash Drive

Modern motherboard BIOSes allow USB Flash Drives to be used to boot the system.

2.3.2 Compact Flash

CF cards are based around NAND Flash technology, though initially it used NOR Flash technology. It was developed by Intel, and is the oldest format of Flash memory. The theoretical maximum capacity of CF is 137 Gigabytes. The transfer speeds have improved with every version of CF, with the latest version 4 CF cards capable of data transfers of 133 Megabytes per second.



A SanDisk CompactFlash card

2.3.3 Flash Memory

“Flash” Memory loosely refers to any non-volatile, rewriteable, random access memory. A Flash Drive or Thumb Drive consists of a Flash Memory chip that stores the data, a controller that manages the read/write operations, and a USB interface. Besides as an integrated unit, Flash memory also exists as distinct memory cards that can be plugged into Memory Card readers that have a USB interface. Memory card types include Compact Flash, Secure Digital, Multimedia, xD, Memory Stick, and more. These differ in their working, but offer similar functionality.

2.3.4 Memory Stick

Developed by Sony, it is available in different versions, like Memory Stick



The Memory Stick Pro Duo is a faster and smaller version of the Memory Stick